HOUSEWIVES MEAL PREP MASTERCLASS

Weekly Family Meal Prep & Pantry Rotation

A complete operational guide for batch cooking, FIFO inventory control, and storage

1 Step 1: 7-Day Family Menu Architecture

Building a predictable weekly menu prevents impulse grocery spending and reduces daily mealtime stress. Successful meal planning balances high-labor fresh meals with quick batch-assembled items while maximizing component overlap across multiple dishes.

Component Overlap Principle

Prepare core ingredients that serve 2-3 distinct meals during the week. Cook a double portion of protein or grain and repurpose it into entirely different regional flavor profiles.

Perishability Sequencing

Schedule tender leafy greens, fish, and soft produce for Monday-Wednesday. Reserve heartier root vegetables, frozen proteins, and cruciferous veggies for Thursday-Sunday.

2 Standardized 7-Day Master Meal Schedule

Day	Dinner Theme	Primary Proteins & Grains	Prep Focus
Mon	Mediterranean Bowl	Roasted Chicken Breasts & Quinoa	Use fresh greens & tender cucumber
Tue	Taco / Fajita Night	Seasoned Ground Beef & Brown Rice	Chop peppers & fresh cilantro
Wed	Sheet Pan Sausage & Veg	Smoked Sausage & Sweet Potatoes	Utilize pre-batched root veggies
Thu	Curry / Stir-Fry	Chicken Breast (repurposed) & Rice	Thaw frozen broccoli & peas
Fri	Homemade Flatbreads	Leftover Beef, Mozzarella, Marinara	Clear out remaining perishable odds
Sat	Slow Cooker Stew	Beef Chuck & Carrots / Potatoes	Low-effort batch simmer
Sun	Sunday Family Roast & Batch Prep	Roast Pork / Chicken, Grains & Greens	Fridge audit & batch prep for coming week

Pro-Tip: Theme Days Reduce Decision Fatigue

Assigning consistent weekly themes limits the decisions you make each week while keeping variety high through rotating spices and sauces. Suggested daily theme names:

- **Monday:** Mediterranean Monday / Meatless Monday
- **Tuesday:** Taco Tuesday / Tex-Mex Night
- **Wednesday:** Sheet-Pan Wednesday / One-Pot Night
- **Thursday:** Takeout-Style Thursday (Curry / Stir-Fry)
- **Friday:** Flatbread & Pizza Friday
- **Saturday:** Slow Cooker & Soup Saturday
- **Sunday:** Sunday Family Roast & Prep Night

3 Step 2: Pantry Inventory & FIFO Management

The **First-In, First-Out (FIFO)** system guarantees that older stock is consumed before newly purchased items, reducing food waste and grocery expenditure.

Pantry Shelf Organization Zone

- **Top Shelf:** Backups, bulk grains, and overstock unopened items.
- **Eye Level:** Everyday staples, opened snacks, and current week ingredients.
- **Bottom Shelf:** Heavy cans, oils, sauces, and heavy root vegetables.

The 3-Zone FIFO Workflow

- **Step 1:** Unload groceries and push older items to the front.
- **Step 2:** Place new items directly behind existing inventory.
- **Step 3:** Label open items with the opening date on masking tape.

4 Step 3 & 4: Batch Chop & Container Protocols

Efficient prep requires treating vegetable cutting and meal assembly like an industrial line. Group similar tasks together rather than prepping meal-by-meal.

Vegetable Category	Prep Method	Storage Container Type	Max Shelf Life
Hard Roots (Carrots, Beets)	Diced or sticks submerged in water	Glass jar with sealed lid	7-10 Days
Cruciferous (Broccoli, Cauliflower)	Floret chops, dry thoroughly	Airtight container + paper towel	5-7 Days
Aromatics (Onions, Garlic)	Fine dice or mince	Sealed glass container (odor control)	4-5 Days
Leafy Greens (Spinach, Kale)	Wash, spin-dry completely	Ventilated container with dry towel	3-5 Days
Soft Veggies (Zucchini, Peppers)	Sliced or diced, keep dry	Airtight silicone or plastic bin	3-4 Days

Standard Container Labeling Formula

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[ ITEM NAME ] | [ PREP DATE ] | [ USE BY DATE ]
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Example: "Chop Bell Peppers | Prep: Oct 22 | Use By: Oct 26"

